

Nitish Kumar Panda

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EXPERIENCE

Level Designer

Dec 2025 – May 2026

Underdogs Studio, Mumbai (Remote)

Confidential Co-op Project

- Designed synchronized co-op puzzles requiring dual-player spatial coordination and communication.
- Built split-path navigation systems ensuring balanced engagement for both players from greybox to iteration.
- Collaborated with lead designers to align environmental flow with core studio objectives.

Level Designer

Feb 2023 – Jan 2024

Akiyam Solutions, Gujarat (Remote)

Assassin: The First List – Steam Release

- Designed and polished 4 full stealth levels from blockout to high-fidelity final environments.
- Developed non-linear level architecture with strategic verticality for multiple gameplay approaches.
- Designed AI guard patrol routes and encounter positioning to maximize player tension.
- Used composition and lighting to ensure objective clarity and readability in professional environments.

PROJECTS

Zombie Survival Level | *Unreal Engine 5, Personal Project*

2026

- Designed underground metro facility with multi-zone layout, choke points, and cover systems for horde encounters.
- Used blood decals and environmental storytelling to communicate danger without UI.

Psychological Horror Prototype | *Unreal Engine 5, Lumen*

Dec 2024

- Designed atmospheric horror environment utilizing negative space and volumetric lighting.
- Controlled emotional pacing through claustrophobic spatial design and shadow-driven storytelling.

3D Hustle | *Unreal Engine 5, Itch.io*

Jan 2025

- Lead Designer: Authored complete GDD and core economy loops.
- Engineered progression systems and spatial navigation mechanics for a high-readability platformer.

The Dyeing World | *Unreal Engine, 3D Platformer*

Oct 2024

- Used color-coded environment shapes to naturally guide player movement through exploration zones.

Santa's Revenge | *Unity, Game Jam, 48 Hours*

Dec 2024

- Designed a complete linear combat arena and enemy encounter pacing under a strict 48-hour deadline.

Mirror Mind & Letter Panic | *Android Studio, VS Code, BrainKraft*

2025 – 2026

- Independently designed, developed, and published 2 mobile games on Google Play Store using AI-assisted workflows.
- Managed full product lifecycle: concept, build, testing, store listing, and post-launch monitoring.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Engines: Unreal Engine 5 (Specialist), Unity, Android Studio, VS Code

Level Design: Greyboxing/Whiteboxing, Combat Pacing, Player Flow, Spatial Puzzles, Navigation

Tech Art Pipeline: Optimization (Nanite, LODs), Lighting (Lumen, Volumetrics), Niagara VFX Basics

Game Design: GDD Documentation, Economy Loops, System Design, Progression Systems

Mobile Dev: Android game pipeline, AI-assisted (vibe) coding workflows, Play Store submission

EDUCATION

KIIT University

Bhubaneswar, India

Master of Computer Applications (MCA), Computer Science

2022 – 2024

Gamer2Maker

Online

Game Design Certification

2024 – 2025